

Problem Set 9.5

Instructor: Robert Rand

1 Recurrence Relations

Problem 1: The recurrence relation for the Towers of Hanoi problem (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Tower_of_Hanoi) is:

$$H_n = 2H_{n-1} + 1$$

where $H_1 = 1$. Find a closed form for H_n via the guess-and-check method.

Problem 2: Solve the following recurrence relation using the geometric series formula:

$$a_n = 2(a_{n-1}) + 7$$

where $a_1 = 8$.

Problem 3: Solve the following homogeneous recurrence relation:

$$a_n = 3a_{n-1} + 10a_{n-2}$$

for $a_1 = 1$ and $a_2 = 33$.

Problem 4: Use your previous solution to solve the inhomogeneous recurrence relation

$$a_n = 3a_{n-1} + 10a_{n-2} + 12$$

for $a_1 = 2$ and $a_2 = 21$.